

2026 AGM

Board of Directors Report – 2025

Introduction

GMBCU is a member-owned and run Credit Union which is regulated by the FCA (Financial Conduct Authority) and the PRA (Prudential Regulatory Authority). We work as a co-operative exclusively providing affordable loans and secure savings for GMB Trade Union members and their families nationally.

GMBCU has been very successful in recent years, growing to become part of a regulatory peer group classed as a large Credit Union with total assets above £12 million and more than 10,000 members.

We are a not-for-profit business, which means we are owned by and responsible to GMB members. We have no external investors and need to produce annual trading surpluses to share with our members as an annual dividend (i.e. interest on savings) and grow our business. However, we must work hard to get the correct balance between retaining sufficient trading surpluses to be financially independent and regulatory strong, whilst sharing our success with members through competitive rates on savings and affordable loans.

Our mission is to empower GMB members in the management and understanding of their money. To achieve this, we provide members with fair and affordable loans and encourage members to develop a savings habit. As our loan book grows, we recycle loan interest earned to pay our bills, build our reserves and pay a competitive annual dividend on member savings.

Many GMB members are worried about their future household finances, and GMBCU is here to support our members for today and in the longer term, so we need to look to the future and plan. The GMBCU Board's role is to provide leadership and a strategy for a better future. We are fully aware of the increased challenges and risks of trading in the challenging operating environment which is likely to prevail for much of the next three year planning period. Concern about the future is understandable; however, we will adapt, and the climate will improve.

Business Plan – Strategic Aims & Objectives

The GMBCU Board remains committed to sustainable growth and in the challenging economic climate, which is likely to prevail for much of the next three years of our business plan, so we will progress with great care.

The Board's has four strategic aims for the period of our next business plan:

-  To increase the operational resilience of GMBCU and maintain a strong balance sheet whilst complying with key regulatory ratios.
-  To sympathetically support the financial wellbeing of GMB members by providing fast, fair, flexible savings and loan services. Provide access to other resources which will enhance our members' financial resilience.
-  Grow our business by developing and deepening our working relationships with GMB members and our key stakeholder GMB Trade Union.
-  Strengthen our Governance and deliver an effective staff succession plan.

To support these strategic aims the Board has the following objectives:

-  To enhance, stabilise and optimise existing and new internal systems, controls and reporting channels.
-  Through education and training, ensure that GMBCU provides excellent customer service and has a continuous and clear understanding of its risk appetites and compliance responsibilities.
-  To effectively implement a cohesive digital service platform and digital marketing programme whilst remaining focused on improving communications with and the financial resilience and wellbeing of GMB members.
-  To grow our membership by working in partnership with GMB regionally and nationally to promote the savings habit and encourage members to borrow responsibly and repay affordably.
-  To gain a greater understanding of our individual members, our business and the marketplace by interrogating whilst safeguarding all our data sources.

Looking ahead to a brighter future

As we move into our 27th trading year, GMBCU remains very positive about the future and our business plans. If you consider that currently we serve around 2% of GMB members nationally, the opportunities for growth are enormous.

The GMBCU Board would like to thank our dedicated staff who have again gone the extra mile to support GMB members, something which is reflected in our excellent Trustpilot rating.

It gives me great pride as a GMBCU Director to read the Trustpilot reviews, and I have included below a sample of some of the latest reviews from GMB members.

Margaret Fennell
Chair & Board Director

11 March 2026

GMB Credit Union
Sinclair House, 11 Station Road
Cheadle Hulme, Cheshire
SK8 5AF